

The Monster in the Cave

A female **hare passing by** a cave heard loud sounds coming from it. "There's some **fearful creature** hiding there!" she thought and **hurried away**. She told everyone there was a monster **holed up** in the cave.

Soon a large number of animals, big and small, **gathered** outside it. "Let us demand that it come out!" said the fox.

"Is that a good idea?" asked the lion, doubtfully. "Oh, all right, go ahead." The fox went close to the mouth of the cave and shouted: "King lion commands that you show yourself!"

The lion **cringed**.

He had not expected the fox to name him.

Little did he **suspect** that the creature inside, far from being **hideous** monster was one of his tiniest **subject**, a frog. Though small it had an extraordinarily loud voice.

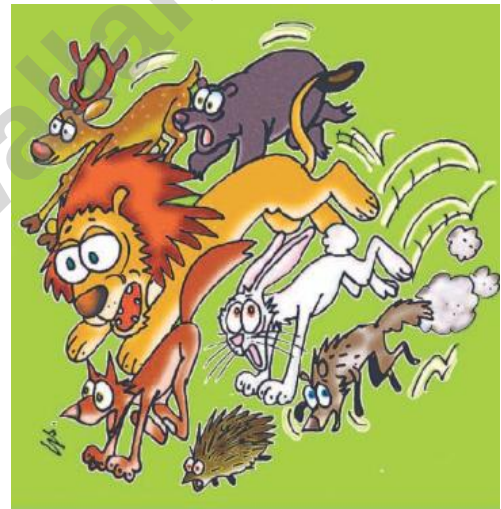
The frog thought fast. He shouted back.

"Who **dares** talk so rudely to me! See, I'm throwing out one of my slippers. It'll turn into a frog and **swallow** your king!"

And with that, the frog **leapt out** of the cave with a loud **croak**.

Seized with terror, the lion turned and **bounded** away, and his subjects **following his example fled pell-mell** in all directions.

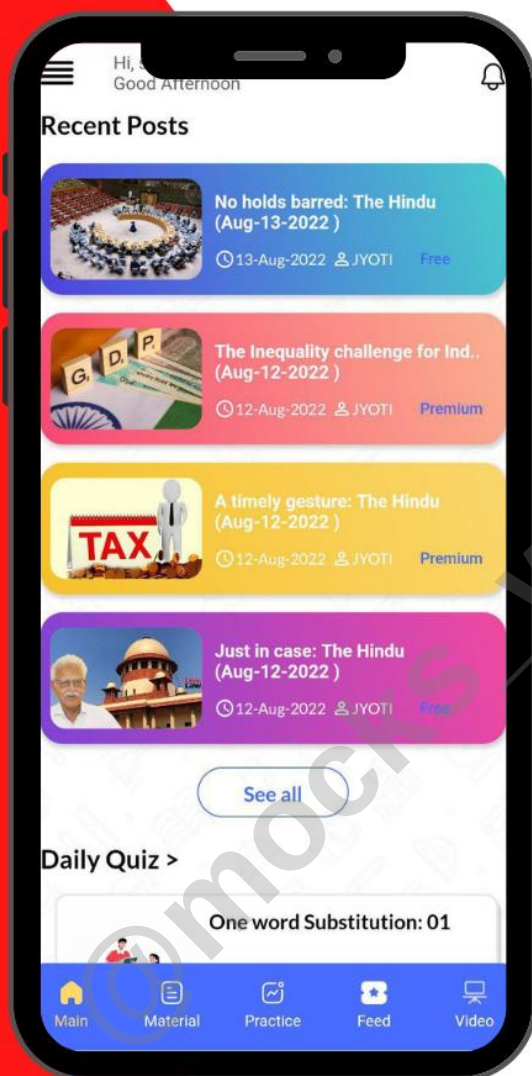
The frog **hopped placidly** to his home in a nearby pond, **vowing** never to go exploring again.



Vocabulary

1. **Hare** (noun) – rabbit, coney, bunny, jackrabbit, leveret खरगोश
2. **Pass by** (phrasal verb) – go past, move along, walk past, travel by, glide by पास से गुजरना
3. **Fearful** (adjective) – afraid, frightened, scared, terrified, anxious डरावना / भयभीत
4. **Creature** (noun) – being, animal, organism, entity, lifeform प्राणी
5. **Hurry away** (phrasal verb) – rush off, dash away, run off, speed away, move quickly तेज़ी से दूर जाना
6. **Hole up** (phrasal verb) – hide out, seclude, take shelter, withdraw, stay hidden छिप जाना
7. **Gather** (verb) – assemble, collect, convene, congregate, rally इकट्ठा होना
8. **Cringe** (verb) – shrink, cower, flinch, wince, tremble सहम जाना
9. **Suspect** (verb) – doubt, mistrust, imagine, assume, suppose संदेह करना
10. **Hideous** (adjective) – ugly, monstrous, gruesome, repulsive, frightful डरावना / भयंकर
11. **Subject** (noun) – citizen, follower, subordinate, vassal, dependent प्रजा
12. **Dare** (verb) – challenge, defy, venture, confront, risk साहस करना / चुनौती देना
13. **Swallow** (verb) – gulp, devour, consume, ingest, eat निगलना
14. **Leap out** (phrasal verb) – jump out, spring out, burst forth, pounce out, bound बाहर कूद पड़ना
15. **Croak** (noun) – hoarse sound, growl, rasp, squawk, ribbit टराने की आवाज
16. **Seize** (verb) – grab, snatch, clutch, grasp, take पकड़ लेना
17. **Bound** (verb) – leap, jump, spring, hop, bounce उछलना
18. **Follow one's example** (phrase) – imitate, emulate, copy, mirror, replicate किसी के जैसा करना
19. **Flee** (verb) – run away, escape, bolt, abscond, retreat भाग जाना
20. **Pell-mell** (noun) – disorder, chaos, confusion, stampede, tumult भगदड़
21. **Hop** (verb) – jump, leap, skip, bounce, bound कूदना
22. **Placidly** (adverb) – calmly, peacefully, serenely, quietly, mildly शांतिपूर्वक
23. **Vow** (verb) – pledge, promise, swear, affirm, undertake कसम खाना

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